

Fleet Street in the 1500's

No. 101

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

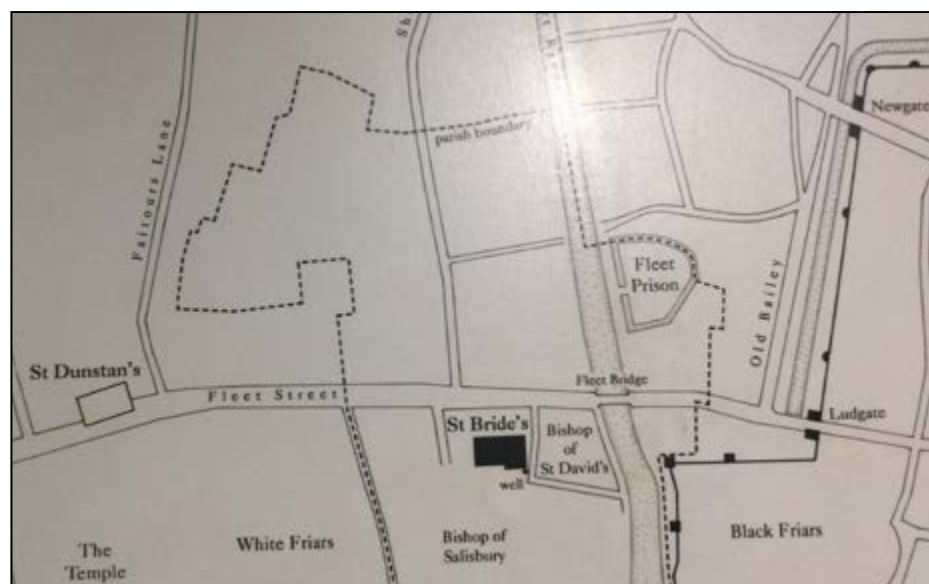
April 2026

In the early 1500s, Fleet Street was a rough road between the City of London and Westminster. Large monasteries owned much of the land and produced handwritten books.

This changed when Henry VIII closed the monasteries (1536–1541). Their land was sold, and new development followed.

Most buildings were small, and news spread by word of mouth because few people could read. Around 1500, printer Wynken de Worde moved his press to Fleet Street, starting its long link with printing.

The website also shows a sketch of Fleet Street in 1500 and part of a map of London from 1572.



Sketch plan of Fleet Street c. 1500

Source: St. Bride Crypt Museum



Map of Tudor London, Hogenberg, 1572